She Never Cared

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by Xenakis (IceRosesCrown)

Summary

When the kingdom of Mystacor is conquered by the Horde, the Rebellion can't act fast enough. They have learnt the Horde's plans, yes, so now they have to think it through, or they will lose the Sea Gate too.

However, Adora and Catra know the enemy well enough to guess exactly how they will proceed, and it doesn't take them much effort to craft the perfect plan. But their task… is to face Shadow Weaver herself, years after escaping her clutches.

Notes

Ok ok, I heavily recommend you read *You Were Mine to Kill* before this, but I guess reading it afterwards can't harm. I say this because you kinda lack context here, but again, you can simply read it as a prequel later on, to understand what the fuck happened.

In any case, this fic is basically the catradora POV of the other one, hence included in this series, Cycles.

Well, happy reading! Beware the angst!

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra was excited as she drove the tank into the village of Thaymore.

Finally! After all that training they were sent to the battlefield!

Not like Shadow Weaver had many choices seeing how Adora had been taken by the Rebellion…

Yes, yes. She had been the only option, which was… disheartening. But, hey! A tank! And if this mission was successful, she'd surely be sent to the battlefield again, right?

—Stop!

A sudden yell from a very familiar voice made Catra bring the tank to a halt.

That was Adora!

Excited again, Catra exited and jumped down, exclaiming —Adora!

—Catra?

The girl's expression of utter disbelief was quite the sight. Of course she didn't expect *her* of all people to be sent there and in a combat vehicle no less!

—They let me drive a tank. Believe it?— she enthusiastically said.

—Catra, I don't understand. What are you doing here?

What kind of question was that!?

—Uh, duh, we came to find you— she replied. —"Cover for me, Catra. No one will even know I'm gone." Seriously, did you just get immediately captured right after you snuck out?— she mocked her, but interrupted herself as she took a better look at the girl. —What are you wearing?

—Uh…— Adora hesitated, and immediately rip the flower from her head. —There's no time. We have to put a stop to this— she frantically said.

—What? Why?

She couldn't be serious…

—Because this is a civilian town— Adora insisted. —Look around! These aren't insurgents. They're innocent people.

—Yeah, sure. Innocent people who kidnapped a Horde officer— she retorted, sarcastic. —Now come on, let's get you back to the Fright Zone. Shadow Weaver is freaking out— she laughed. But then thought about it a bit better and pointed out —It'd be funny if she weren't such a terrible person.

—Catra, no. I can't go back— she immediately replied. —Not until the Horde leaves this town alone. You have to help me.

What was she- That wasn’t the Adora she knew…

—What are you saying?

—I’m saying, this is wrong. They've been lying to us, manipulating us. Hordak, Shadow Weaver, all of them— she argued.

Well, well. Until she finally caught on…

—Duh! Did ya just figure that out? Manipulation is Shadow Weaver's whole thing— Catra let out, condescendingly. —She's been messing with our heads since we were kids.

—How could you possibly be okay with that?

—Because it doesn't matter what they do— she answered, without missing a beat. —The two of us look out for each other. And soon we'll be calling the shots— she reminded her. —Now, can we go home already?

—I'm not going home, Catra. I can't. Not after everything I've seen— she argued. —Come with me. You don't have to go back there. We can fix this— Adora invited her. But Catra hesitated a moment too long. So the girl pleaded —Please, Catra, come with me. I need you; we protect each other, remember? We promised…

—We can't just throw away all those years of sacrifice!— Catra cried out. —It was all so we could rule the world together!— she insisted.

—Sacrifice!? I don't want us to suffer, I don't want *you* to suffer!— Adora countered. —Please! I can't go back now… and I don't want to leave you…

—The rebellion isn't for us, Adora. It isn't for me— Catra pointed out.

—I'll make sure it is— Adora immediately said, stepping forward to grab her hands. —If they turn you down, I'll leave too. It's either both of us or none— she vowed.

She was really choosing her!? She… wanted to take her away from the torture of the Horde? Even if, in the end, they were rejected by the Rebellion too?

With a new, hopeful expression, Catra asked —You promise?

—I promise.

Adora looked so sure with that little smile.

—But I'm only going because the Horde will suck if you're not there for me to beat during trainings, not because I like you— the girl said, making her laugh.

—Huh, sure… You mean playing dirty to win.

—I still win, don't I?— Catra smugly told her.

Laughing together, they finally walked away from the battlefield, finding the Rebellion Princess and the boy with arrows… They didn't trust Catra, but they sure trusted Adora, so they preferred not to argue, and simply asked Adora to use the power of something called "She-Ra"…

—Catra?

Adora calling her name extracted the girl from her reminiscing. She looked back with a smile, realizing again she had made the right decision back then, and approached her as she admired the white and golden dress she wore.

—Hey, Adora. Looking nice…

—You don't look bad yourself— she replied, adjusting Catra's red shirt and dusting a bit the white half-cape on her left shoulder. —What were you daydreaming about just now? I called you three times…

—Oh, nothing. Some… nice memories— the girl replied.

—Alright then. Now we have to go.

—Did something happen? Have you caught the mole?

—Yes. It was "Fluterina". They're actually a shape-shifter and we're gonna interrogate them now.

—Oh, I don't want to miss that!

The interrogation lasted a few hours. It was difficult to speak with this individual, whose name was apparently "Double Trouble", but eventually Princess Glimmer managed to make them speak with a truth spell she had learnt from her father.

The information they had, however, sent a chill down their spine.

Mystacor was under attack… Or rather, had already fallen.

—Dad!— Glimmer exclaimed. —And Auntie! We have to go!

—Alright. We have to…

—Wait— Adora interrupted Bow. —Let's finish the interrogation first— she said, approaching Double Trouble. —I know how the Horde works, and this is far away from the usual. They used you as a distraction, yes. But why Mystacor?

—I- Ah… I…— the shape-shifter struggled, wanting to resist the spell. —They plan to take the Sea Gate!— they finally let out. —And from Mystacor they have the advantage!— they

added. —Ugh… I was not paid for this…

—Salineas!— Mermista exclaimed, once out of her shock. —They are going to…

—We won't allow it— Catra interrupted. —But… if we're intelligent enough, we can also recover Mystacor.

—How!?— Glimmer asked, desperate. —Why don't we go *now*!?

—No, no. Now is not the time— she insisted. —Listen. When the attack on the Sea Gate begins, all their troops will be there. Mystacor will be defenseless, especially because, if we didn't act before, they will think they are safe enough up there.

—So what do you plan?— Bow asked, thoughtful.

—You guys go repel the attack on the Sea Gate. Adora and I will recover Mystacor. We just need a handful of Bright Moon's soldiers to help.

—That… can work, right?— Perfuma commented. —If we work together…

—Wait, wait. But we *need* She-Ra!— Mermista interrupted. —My people are at stake!

—That's true. I-I could go recover Mystacor instead— Glimmer proposed.

—No. I'm sure Shadow Weaver will be there— Catra argued. —*We* know her. *We* have to go. You all have enough power to repel the attack. We saw what you can do when you all are in sync.

—You really trust we can win, don't you?— Frosta reflected. —Fine. Strategically speaking, it makes sense. You both know the Horde better. And if we don't have Mystacor's help, only *you* can face that witch, Shadow Weaver— she sentenced, leaving everyone speechless with her wise words.

—Then it's settled. Prepare everything to resist the attack at Salineas. As soon as it begins, we'll go to Mystacor— Adora pronounced, expression serious. —We'll take only enough soldiers to back us up, and as we free the prisoners we'll have more people to fight. We can lead the troops on foot because the battle reports won't reach Mystacor fast enough. They won't see us coming until it's too late.

—Battle reports?— Bow asked.

—They will be expecting She-Ra and me to be with you, but when they realize we're not there, they will send their fastest scouts with a warning— Catra explained.

—But we know who those are— Adora continued, smirking smugly as she glanced at her. —They can fly but not fast enough.

—If you don't come with us, how will you know when the attack begins?— Mermista asked.

—Oh, I can let them know through my tracker pad— Bow realized.

—Exactly.

—Then we have a plan— Glimmer concluded. —I'll run it through my mom and we can start moving.

—Then we better get changed— Adora told Catra.

The news about Mystacor being overtaken by the Horde shocked the Queen, as expected, and her reaction was the same as her daughter's.

Micah was there. What could have happened to him?

But as the Princess quickly explained how they planned on recovering the kingdom soon, the Queen's distress slowly settled. It was difficult for Angella to stay hopeful when they had been fooled by the Horde so easily by means of that shape-shifter, yet Glimmer's confidence in their plan helped her stay calm and think positive.

However, when the time finally came, barely two days later, the Queen could barely stay still. She wanted to assist in Mystacor's recovery, but they feared what could happen to her, and with the King gone, her safety had to be her priority.

She had to trust She-Ra.

The hours that went by until news arrived felt eternal, but the moment the Queen was told the floating island had been successfully recovered and the King appeared to be safe and sound, she almost passed out.

All the tension that kept her awake those days finally melted away, and Angella's exhaustion took over her. She could only think of her husband returning home safe and sound and, without noticing, she fell asleep on the throne.

No one dared wake her up.

—Mom?— Glimmer called, shaking the Queen awake. —Mom, we're all back— she insisted.

—I… When did I fall asleep?— she let out, sitting straight on her throne. —I'm sorry. Are you alright?— she asked, slowly getting rid of the drowsiness.

—We are— she assured her, although her expression seemed conflicted.

—But did something happen? What's with that look? Is your father alright?— the Queen questioned her, alarmed.

—Yes, yes. It's just…— Glimmer began, but interrupted herself as she looked down. —We… may have to… judge him— she finally let out.

—What? Why!?

But the Princess couldn't speak anymore, and turned to look at Bow, who had been standing a few steps lower. When he saw Glimmer's expression, he approached and placed a hand on her shoulder before answering the Queen.

—Your Majesty… King Micah killed someone— he explained. —The Horde's sorceress… Shadow Weaver— he concluded.

After seeing through that basin in Mystacor that the deceased Head Sorceress was somewhere in the Whispering Woods, Shadow Weaver crafted a little magical artifact that could lead them to her.

—Only *I* can keep this active, for I made it with *my* magic— the woman said. —So you can send me to Bright Moon as a prisoner and run around the Woods on your own trying to find her… Or you follow me— she told them, her tone condescending, as was usual from her.

Catra wouldn't say it, but she'd rather keep the woman around, to make sure she didn't try to end her life or train someone else into killing her. So she didn't have to think twice.

—I say we follow her.

—I agree— Adora seconded her. —I understand your feeling, King Micah, but the priority is to find your sister as soon as possible— she argued.

—Alright— he resignedly accepted, folding his arms. —But if she tries anything, I won't hesitate to kill her— he threatened, squinting at the woman as he pronounced the last words.

And so they followed her into the Woods. They expected her to keep provoking the King on the way there, or at least to make a comment, anything. Yet the woman silently led the way, possibly deep in thought.

It wasn't until they reached the clearing where the sorceress had fallen, that she finally acted up.

As soon as Micah saw his sister, he fell on his knees, covering his mouth, seemingly about to cry.

—King Micah— Adora let out, concerned, and knelt next to him.

Catra followed and tried to soothe him, saying —We're so sorry. I wish we knew earlier…

—I lost her— he sobbed, voice muffled.

However, as they were distracted calming him down, the dark sorceress approached the body of Castaspella. Before any of them could see her move, Shadow Weaver cast some form of darkness that enveloped her and the Head Sorceress.

—No!— they all exclaimed, standing up immediately.

They couldn't see through the black wall, nor could they walk through it. The King began punching it fiercely, trying to break it, but it was all in vain. Meanwhile, the girls remained frozen, knowing they couldn't stop him and unsure what to do.

He then stepped back, draw a sigil in front of him, and shot at the dark barrier. The man was so enraged that the girls exchanged a scared look and stayed back.

—I'll tear this spell down and kill you!— he yelled, right before shooting again and cracking the wall of darkness. He let out a furious cry and fired again, finally breaking Shadow Weaver's spell, and stalked at her as he ordered —Get away from her!

He was going to kill her.

Adora and Catra immediately reacted, they had to stop him, but they were a second too late. The sorcerer obviously knew the girls wanted to keep the woman alive, so he created his own barrier behind him.

—Go ahead, Micah! Fulfill your promise!— Shadow Weaver taunted.

That woman!

Now it was their turn to frantically punch the invisible wall, but without sorcery, they couldn't break it. Perhaps She-Ra's power could take it down, yet Adora panicked when she saw Micah's staff pointed at the sorceress' chest, glowing with a spell.

And the next moment… Shadow Weaver fell back, eyes closed, never to wake up again.

Her head rested on Castaspella's chest, and the King took a moment too long to move her aside, while the girls cried out desperately…

—Catra— Adora called, once again shaking the girl awake from her thoughts. —Are… you alright?

—I still… see it in my head. We couldn't…

—I know— Adora interrupted, embracing Catra. —But we did what we could…

—I don't- I understand why he- I-I don't blame him— the girl stammered. —But-but I didn't… want this to happen! Why did *she* want to die so badly!?

—I don't know— Adora replied, her voice strained as a knot formed in her throat. —She was… so defeated.

—She didn't care… We told her we didn't want her dead, but she didn't care— Catra sobbed as a single tear escaped her. She let go of Adora and brushed it away before asking —Is it time?

—Yes. We have to tell them what happened. We're the only witnesses.

—I know…

—What will you say?

—I'll just retell the events, alright? You don't have to speak if you don't want to— Adora reminded her.

—Alright…

The throne room was almost empty. Only the Queen, the Princesses, and both Adora and Catra, wearing their formal clothes again, were present at the "trial". King Micah stood in the middle of the room, right in front of the stairs that led to the thrones, looking down with a furious frown.

As Adora retold the events since finding Shadow Weaver and coming across the King, the man reviewed everything in his head. And his wrath was rekindled with every word.

—…Then, when he broke the barrier of darkness that Shadow Weaver put up, he… raised one to keep *us* away. We couldn't stop him— Adora finally said.

—It proves intent of murder— Angella sadly stated. —Is there anything…

—She wanted to be killed!— Catra suddenly yelled, interrupting the Queen. Her expression was a mix of rage and sorrow, tears forming in her eyes and her voice broken. —Since we found her! She had been trying to convince us to kill her! We refused, so she kept taunting the King to make him kill her instead!— she continued. Now several tears were falling down her cheeks as her voice boomed through the otherwise silent room. —She died because she wanted to! She-she abandoned us! E-even when we told her we wanted her here!— Catra cried. —She didn't care! She never cared!— she concluded. The girl fell to her knees, and Adora couldn't help kneeling next to her to give her a tight hug. However, she looked up again, looked the King in the eyes, and asked —Why did you do it? Why would you help her… Why?

Micah looked down, sighed, and admitted —I can't apologize.

—I know— Catra replied. —That's the worst part. I can't forgive you… Because you will be pardoned for this. As you should, I understand. But now I will never…

"I will never find out if she cared", the girl wanted to say, yet had no strength left to pronounce it.

End Notes

How many times do I have to apologize now? <("^_^)
So, so, so sorry for the angst, fr, but I had to do it. This is just a perfect complement for *You Were Mine to Kill*, and I've been meaning to write it for a long time…

In any case, I hope you could still enjoy it regardless, and thank you for reading!!!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!